
Quick Start & Testing Guide

A guided tour of the Equus Internship Assessment Portal for the program team — everything you need to sign in, explore each area, and put it through its paces.

AUDIENCE

PROGRAM STAFF & TESTERS

ENVIRONMENT

STAGING / TEST

VERSION

2026-09-22 • V2

GETTING INTO THE TEST ENVIRONMENT

The Equus portal tracks interns through your program — from intake and entry assessment, through competency and self-assessments, to 90- and 180-day employment outcomes. This guide walks the **admin (program-staff)** experience so you can test every area.

TEST ENVIRONMENT ACCESS

TEST URL

Shared with your invite

SIGN-IN

Email + password

EMAIL

admin@example.com

PASSWORD

DevPassword123!

THIS IS A SANDBOX

You're working against a **test database seeded with realistic demo data** — ~25 employers, ~40 cohorts, and ~140 interns. Click freely: you can't hurt real program data, and the dataset can be refreshed at any time. **Do not use the live production site for testing** — intern submissions there are permanent.

The three kinds of user

ADMIN

Program staff

Full access — manages employers, cohorts, interns, assessments, reports, and accounts. This is the role you'll test with.

EMPLOYER

Partner orgs

Signs in to see only their own cohorts and interns, and to complete competency & exit surveys for them.

INTERN

Anonymous

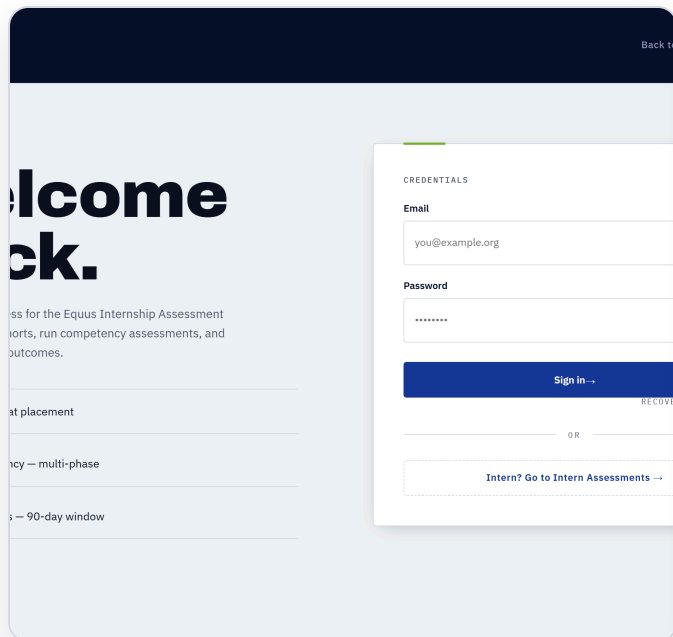
No login. Enters their Intern ID (plus employer and cohort) and completes three one-time self-assessments.

HOW TO READ THIS GUIDE

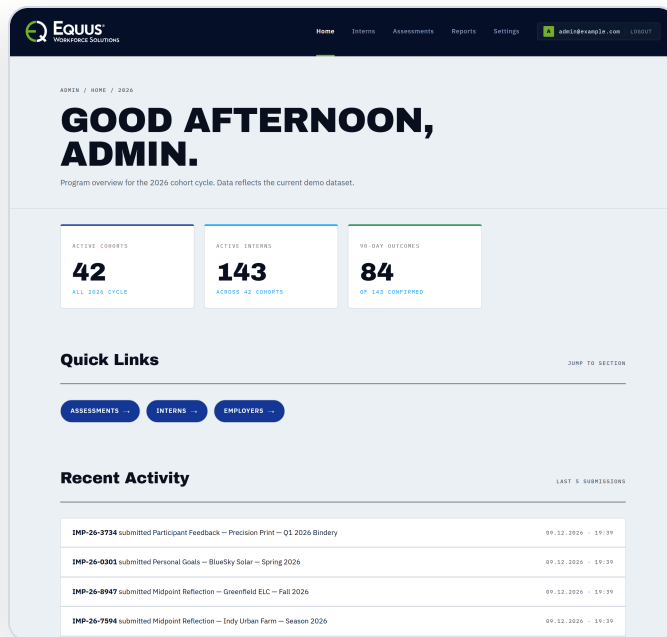
Each section pairs a short explanation with a screenshot of the real screen. Things worth trying are called out in blue; things to be aware of are in green.

LOGGING IN & GETTING ORIENTED

- 1 Open the test URL — you'll land on the branded **Sign in** screen.
- 2 Enter the admin email and password from the access card on the previous page.
- 3 You'll arrive at the **admin home** dashboard for the current cohort cycle.



THE SIGN-IN SCREEN



ADMIN HOME — KPIS & RECENT ACTIVITY

The top navigation is your map. Every admin area hangs off these five tabs:



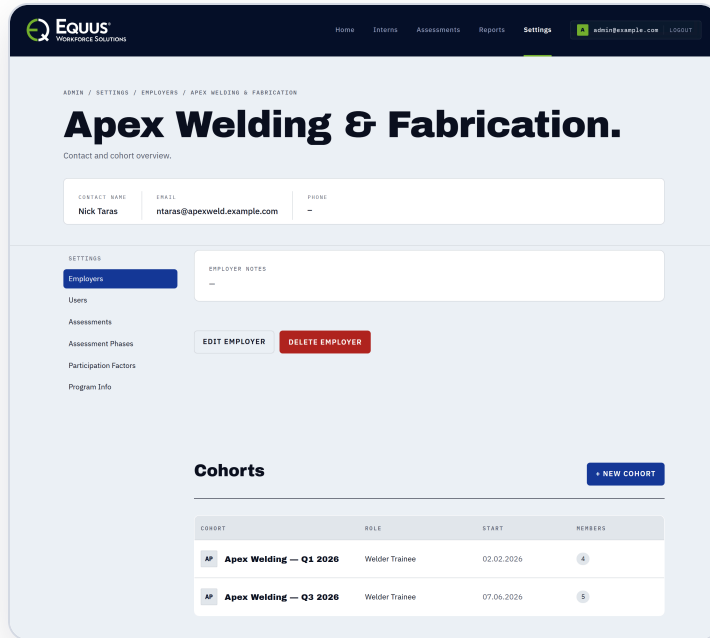
- **Home** — program-at-a-glance: active cohorts, active interns, 90-day outcomes, and the latest submissions.
- **Interns** — the roster and each intern's full record.
- **Assessments** — start competency & exit-employer surveys, and review intern self-assessments.
- **Reports** — program metrics with employer/cohort filters.
- **Settings** — employers, cohorts, users, phases, participation factors, questions, and program info.

TRY THIS

From Home, use the **Quick Links** to jump straight into Assessments, Interns, or Employers, then use the browser back button to return.

EMPLOYERS & COHORTS

Your program's structure is built in **Settings** → **Employers**. An employer has **roles** (the kinds of placement they offer) and **cohorts** (a group of interns running over a date range). Cohorts are where interns live.

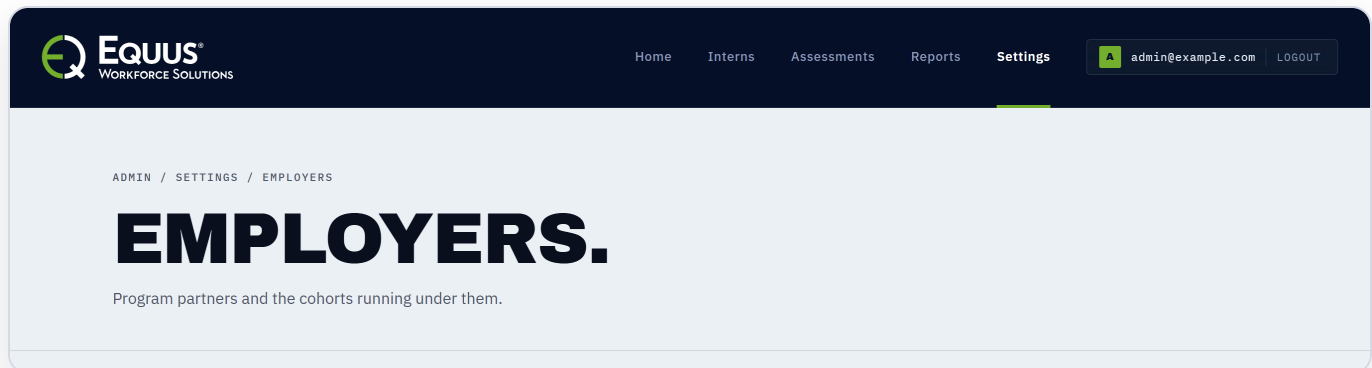


The hierarchy:



- Open any employer row to see its cohorts and roles.
- **+ New Cohort** / **+ New Role** add to that employer.
- Each cohort selects which **phases** apply (see §7).
- **Account access** invites that employer to sign in and self-serve their assessments.

EMPLOYER DETAIL — COHORTS, ROLES & ACCOUNT ACCESS



SETTINGS → EMPLOYERS — THE FULL PARTNER LIST (ROWS ARE CLICKABLE)

TRY THIS

Click **+ New Employer**, add a fictional org, then open it and add a role and a cohort. You've just built a place to put interns.

INTERNS & THEIR RECORDS

The **Interns** tab is the roster. Each intern record is a single page that holds intake, the entry assessment, self-assessment status, evaluations, and employment outcomes.

On the record you'll find:

- **Identity & placement** — locked after creation.
- **Entry Assessment** — participation factors at intake + notes.
- **Self-Assessments** — which of the three the intern has submitted.
- **Evaluations** — competency & exit-survey status.
- **Employment Details** — 90-day & 180-day outcome checkboxes + notes.

MINIMUM-PII BY DESIGN

The portal stores **no intern name**. Each intern gets a portal-assigned Intern ID (**IMP-26-0417**) when the record is saved; program staff keep the ID-to-person roster offline and give the intern their ID at intake.

A FULL INTERN RECORD

TRY THIS

Open an intern, tick **Employed at 90 days**, add a note, and Save — then watch the 90-day number move on Home and Reports.

COMPETENCY & EXIT-EMPLOYER SURVEYS

From the **Assessments** tab, admins complete two kinds of evaluation *on behalf of employers*: the **Competency Rubric** and the **Exit Employer Survey**. You pick an intern, then fill the form.

ADMIN / ASSESSMENTS / NEW

NEW COMPETENCY ASSESSMENT.

Capture a phase-specific competency evaluation for an active intern. Combines shared professional domains with role-specific skills for the placement.

Participant Record UNIQUE KEY • INTERN ID • MULTIPLE PHASES ALLOWED

INTERN	COHORT	EMPLOYER	ROLE	START
IMP-25-0001	Lakeside Auto — Winter 2025 Lot	Lakeside Auto Group	Lot Attendant	11.03.2025
END				

PHASE

PASS = ALL READY

[CANCEL](#) [SUBMIT ASSESSMENT →](#)

TIER

Professional Competencies

THE COMPETENCY RUBRIC — 7 SHARED PROFESSIONAL DOMAINS PLUS ROLE-SPECIFIC SKILLS

HOW IT WORKS

Each domain is rated **Emerging / Developing / Ready** with room for notes. Competency is **phase-specific** — the phase dropdown is filtered to the intern's cohort.

THREE-TIER RUBRIC

Questions stitch together at assessment time: program-wide **Core 7** + per-cohort role skills + any per-intern items (authored in Settings → Questions).

TRY THIS

Start a competency assessment from the Assessments tab (pick any intern), rate a few domains, and submit. Then reopen the intern to see the evaluation recorded.

INTERN SELF-ASSESSMENTS

Interns complete their own reflections through a **public, login-free** flow. They confirm their identity once, then complete up to three one-time forms: Personal Goals, Midpoint Reflection, and Participant Feedback.

- Identity = **Intern ID + employer + cohort** — the ID is issued by the portal when staff create the record.
- Each form is **one submission per intern and immutable** once sent.
- Admins review every submission under **Assessments → Self-assessment results**.

HEADS UP

Because self-assessments are permanent, test them in staging only — never on the live site.

THE INTERN'S IDENTITY CHOOSER (PUBLIC)

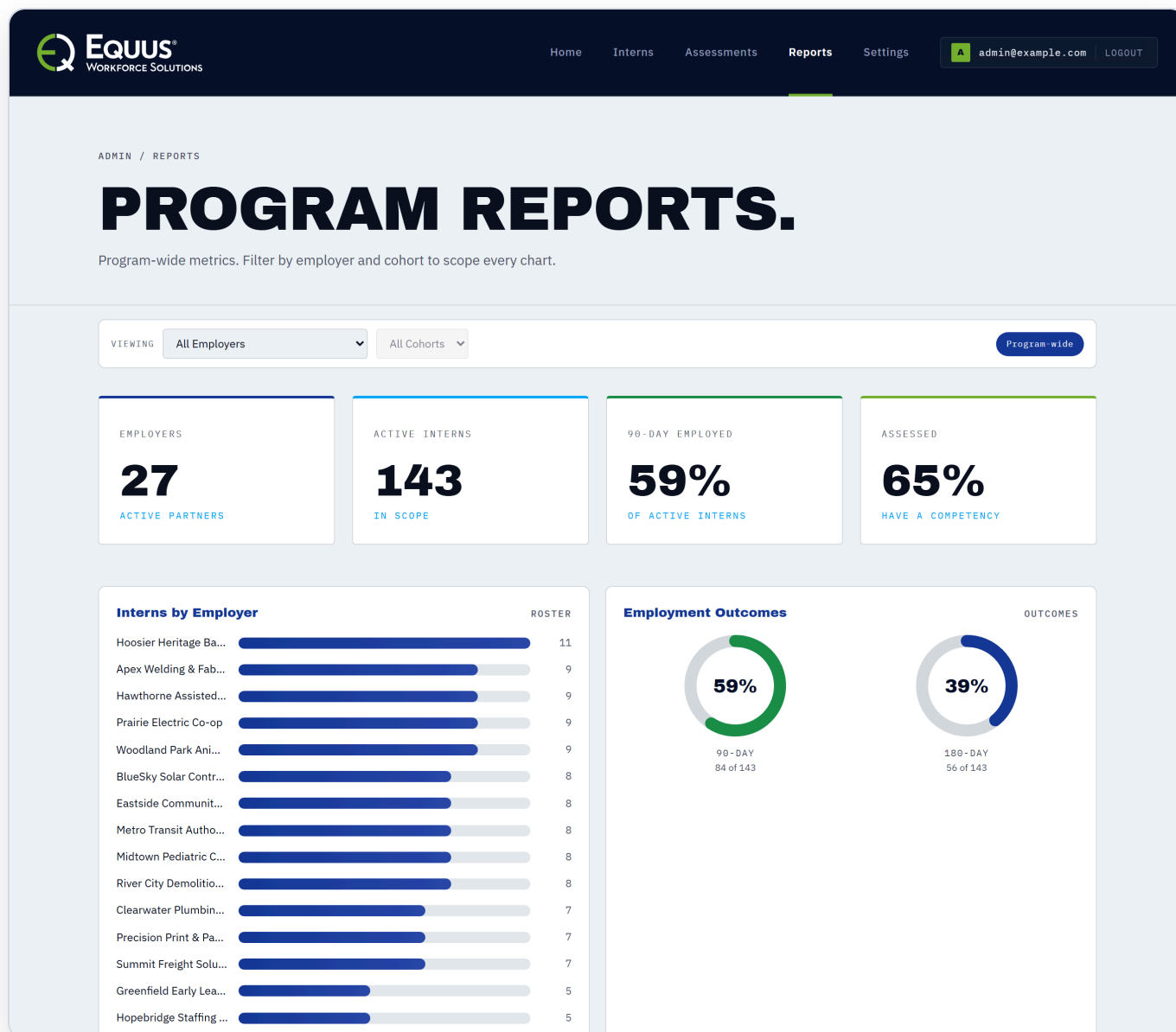
ADMIN VIEW — SUBMITTED SELF-ASSESSMENTS

TRY THIS

From the test URL, open `/intern/assessments`, pick an employer and cohort, enter an intern's ID (from the Interns list), and walk through Personal Goals.

THE REPORTS DASHBOARD

Reports turns the data into program metrics. Use the **Viewing** filters at the top to scope everything from program-wide down to a single employer or cohort.



PROGRAM REPORTS — KPIS, EMPLOYMENT GAUGES, COMPLETION METERS, PARTICIPATION FACTORS & SUBMISSIONS TREND

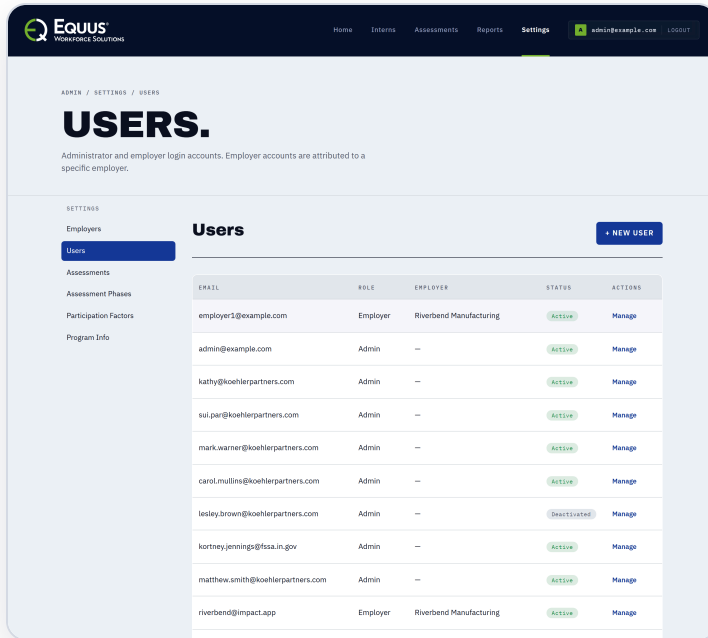
- **KPI tiles** — employers, active interns, 90-day employment, % assessed.
- **Employment Outcomes** — 90- and 180-day gauges.
- **Assessment Completion** — how far each assessment type has progressed.
- **Participation Factors & Submissions Over Time** round out the picture.

TRY THIS

Set **Viewing** to a single employer and watch every chart re-scope; then click **Program-wide** to reset.

SETTINGS & USER MANAGEMENT

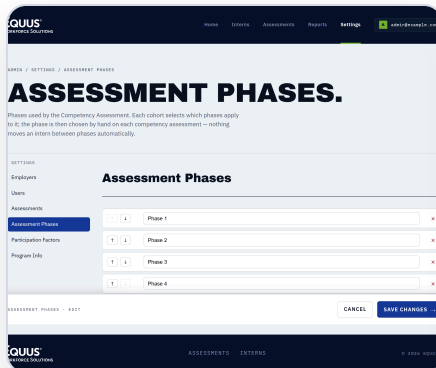
Settings is where you configure the program and manage who can sign in. The left rail lists every area; **Users** is the newest.



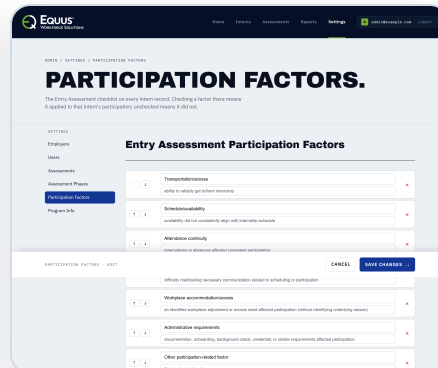
Users lets you:

- Create an **admin** or **employer** account (employer accounts attach to an employer).
- Set a password now, or send an invite email.
- Change a role and **deactivate** / **reactivate** an account (reversible).

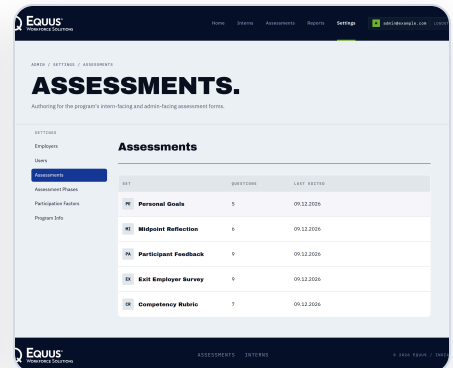
SETTINGS → USERS — ADMIN & EMPLOYER ACCOUNTS



ASSESSMENT PHASES



PARTICIPATION FACTORS



ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

GOOD TO KNOW

A role change takes effect the next time that user logs in. On staging, invite/reset **emails won't actually deliver yet** (custom email is still being set up) — so use **“set a password now”** when creating test accounts.

TESTING CHECKLIST & FEEDBACK

A suggested run-through that touches every area. Tick them off as you go — and tell us anything that feels confusing, looks off, or doesn't behave as you'd expect.

Exercise the full loop

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Sign in and tour all five nav tabs | ☐ Create a new employer, role & cohort |
| ☐ Add a new intern to a cohort | ☐ Record participation factors & notes |
| ☐ Complete a competency assessment | ☐ Complete an exit-employer survey |
| ☐ Submit an intern self-assessment | ☐ Mark a 90-day employment outcome |
| ☐ Filter Reports by employer & cohort | ☐ Create a test user in Settings → Users |
| ☐ Deactivate, then reactivate that user | ☐ Log out and back in |

KNOWN LIMITATIONS ON STAGING

- Invite & password-reset **emails don't deliver yet** — use “set a password now.”
- Role changes apply on the user's **next login**, not instantly.
- Test data may be **refreshed/reset** between rounds — don't rely on anything you enter persisting.

WHEN SOMETHING'S WRONG

Note **what you did**, **what you expected**, and **what happened** — a screenshot and the page URL help a lot. Send it to Matt by your agreed channel.